

4.2 Strategy

Games in this genre are all about planning, and are much slower-paced than those in the Action genre—but no less enthralling!

Age Of Empires III

Very recently released, the *Age Of Empires III* (AOE3) demo has been provided on the Digit DVD this month. *Age Of Empires*, the first in the series, was perhaps the game that defined the entire ‘Strategy’ genre of games. It was the first popular game to change the old, boring 2D look of strategy games and convert them into a 3D look, complete with 3D men, machines and maps.

Age Of Empires III does not change much in terms of gameplay, and this is a good thing. Why fix something that isn’t broken? The difference is that AOE3 takes place in a little more modern setting, and everyone starts as a European power, all battling for control over North and South America. Though you do not get the entertainment of pitting the Japanese against the Persians as you could in the earlier games, you still can have a lot of fun playing as the British and fighting off the French, Spaniards, Dutch, Russians, Portuguese, German or the Ottomans.

As is customary in the series, each civilisation has its own advantages and drawbacks, and who you choose to play as, dictates your strategy, just as much as anything else in the game. There’s a nice, long single-player campaign mode, which will give you hours and hours of exciting gameplay, with great replayability. The skir-



Age of Empires III brings some great graphics to RTS games